



MY COIN CATALOG

A simple app for keeping pictures and notes about every coin in your collection. It works on your phone and on your computer, and it keeps your pictures to yourself.

The app's address on the internet is:

coinmax-coder.github.io/coin-catalog

Three things to know



Your coin pictures stay **on your own phone or computer**. They are never sent anywhere.



There is **no account and no password**. The app never asks for money or personal details.



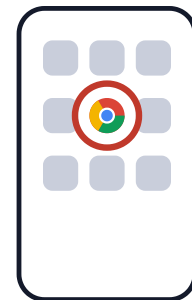
Save a **backup** once a month so you never lose your collection (see page 14).

SETTING UP AN ANDROID PHONE

You only do this once on each phone. Afterwards a gold coin called **My Coins** on the home screen opens the app, even without internet.

Before you start: the phone should be on Wi-Fi. You will use the **Chrome** app, the round red, yellow and green circle with a blue middle.

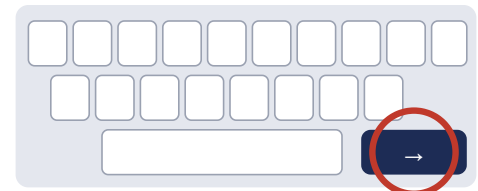
- 1 Find **Chrome** on the phone's home screen and tap it.



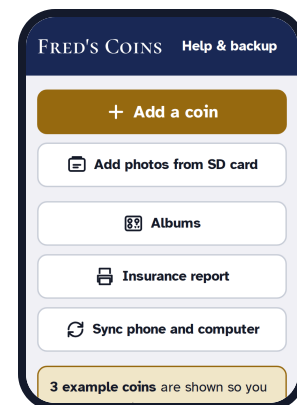
Chrome

- 2 Tap the long bar at the top. Type **coinmax-coder.github.io/coin-catalog** and tap the  or **Go** key.

coinmax-coder.github.io/coin-catalog



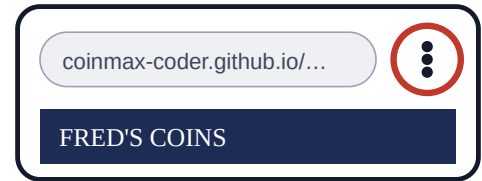
- 3 The app opens with **Fred's Coins** across the top. You are halfway there.



ANDROID PHONE, CONTINUED

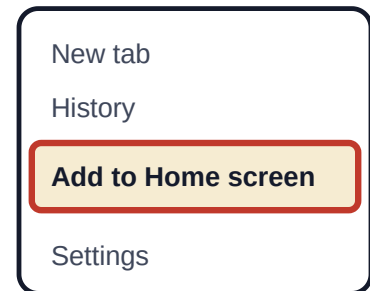
4

Tap the  button (three dots) in the top right corner of Chrome.



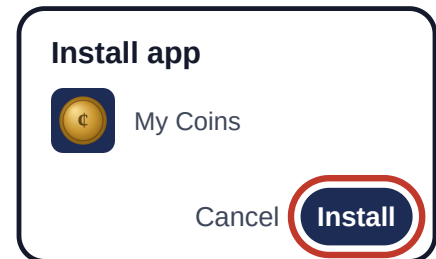
5

Tap **Add to Home screen**. On some phones it says **Install app** instead.



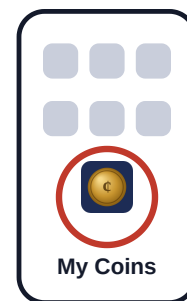
6

If it asks, choose **Install** (not "Create shortcut"). Then tap **Install** once more.



7

Go back to the home screen. The gold coin called **My Coins** is there now. From now on, tap it to open your coins.



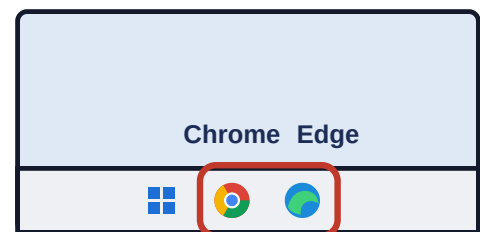
No "Add to Home screen"? Make sure you opened **Chrome**, not the phone's own "Internet" app, and start again at step 1.

SETTING UP A WINDOWS COMPUTER

This is just as easy, and you only do it once. Afterwards the app opens from the **Start** menu like any other program.

Before you start: use **Chrome** or **Microsoft Edge** (the blue and green wave). Both work the same way.

1 Click **Chrome** or **Edge** in the bar along the bottom of the screen, or double-click it on the desktop.

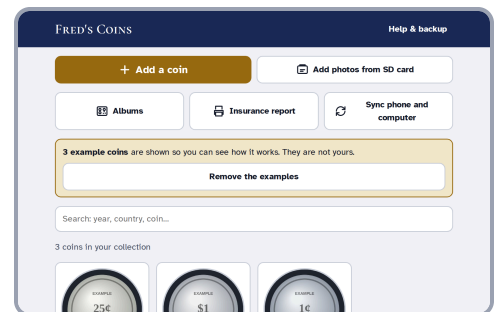


2 Click the long bar at the top, type **coinmax-coder.github.io/coin-catalog** and press the **Enter** key.

coinmax-coder.github.io/coin-catalog

Enter

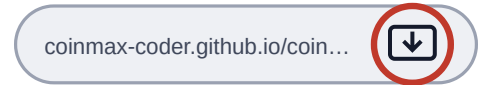
3 The app opens with **Fred's Coins** across the top.



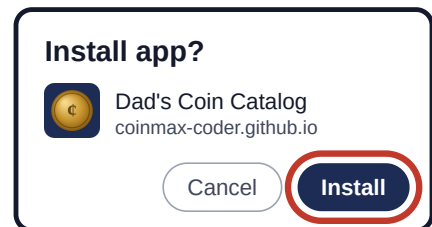
WINDOWS COMPUTER, CONTINUED

Click the small **install** picture at the right end of the address bar. In

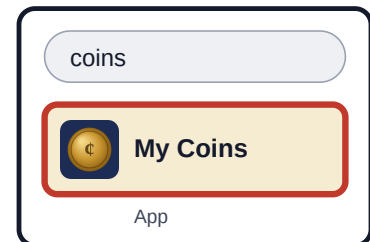
- 4 Chrome it looks like a screen with an arrow. In Edge it is a few squares with a plus.



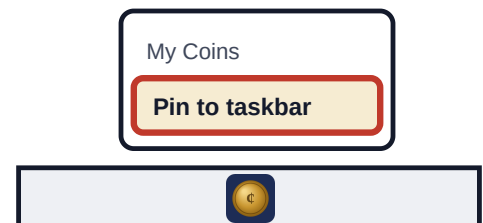
- 5 A box asks **Install app?** Click **Install**.



- 6 The app opens in its own window. To open it another day, click **Start** and type **coins**, then click **My Coins**.



- 7 **Handy extra:** while the app is open, right-click the gold coin in the bar at the bottom and choose **Pin to taskbar**. It will always be one click away.



No install picture? Click  (or  in Edge) at the top right and look for **Install**. It may be under **Cast, save and share** or **Apps**.

ADDING YOUR COINS

One coin at a time

- 1 Tap the big gold **+ Add a coin** button.
- 2 Under **Front**, tap **Take photo** to use the phone's camera, or **Choose file** to pick a microscope picture. Do the same for the **Back**.
- 3 Under **Type of coin**, pick it from the list, for example **Lincoln Wheat cent**. Then pick the **date and mint mark**. The year, country, coin name and mint mark fill in by themselves.
- 4 Fill in the rest if you like: condition, price paid and notes. Anything can be left empty.
- 5 Tap **Save this coin**.

◀ Back ADD A COIN

Type of coin
Pick it from the list of U.S. coins and the year, mint mark and name fill in by themselves.

Lincoln Wheat cent ▼

Which date and mint mark?

1914-D (key date) ▼

Year

1914

Country

United States

Coin

Lincoln cent

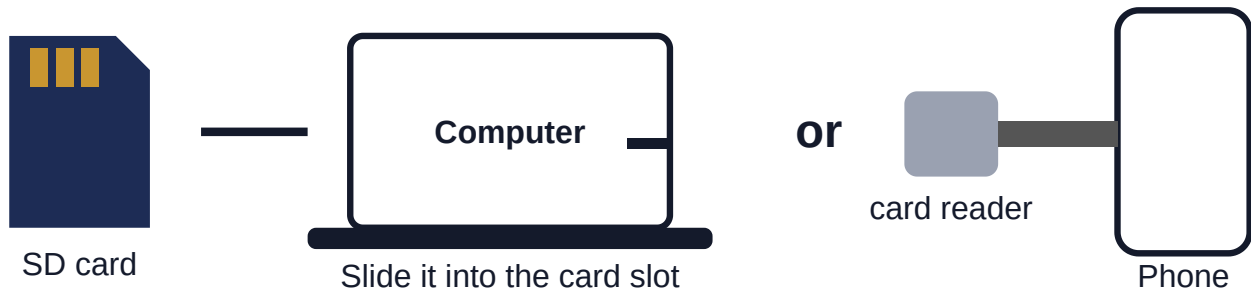
Mint mark

The list has **United States coins** from 1859 on. If your coin is from another country, or not on the list, choose **Not on the list, or not sure** and type the details yourself.

ADDING PICTURES FROM THE SD CARD

Many microscope pictures at once

Your microscope saves its pictures on a small **SD card**. You can bring in many pictures at once and fill in the details later.



- 1 Put the SD card into the computer, or into a small card reader plugged into the phone.
- 2 Tap **Add photos from SD card**.
- 3 Open the SD card, select the pictures you want, and tap **Open** or **Select**.

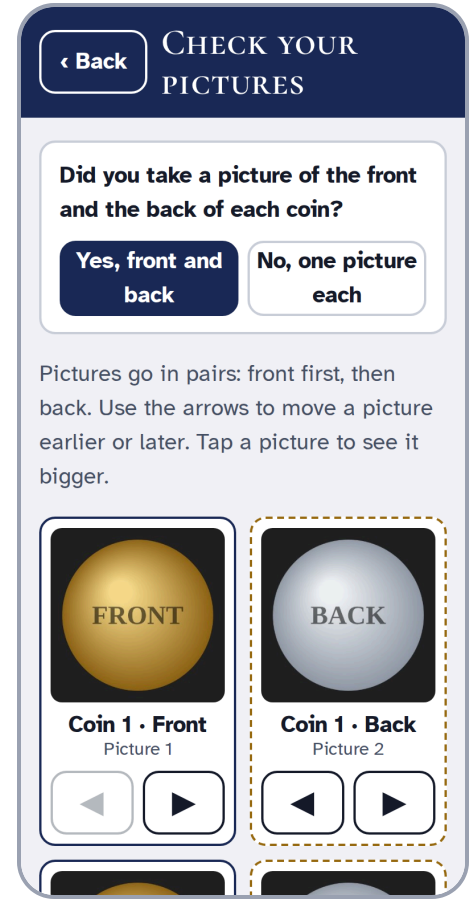
On a phone: if you only see recent photos, tap  or **Browse** and choose the SD card from the list.

FRONT AND BACK

After you pick the pictures, the app shows them **6 at a time** and asks one question:

"Did you take a picture of the front and the back of each coin?"

- 1 Tap **Yes, front and back** if you did. The app pairs them in the order you took them: **front, then back**. Otherwise tap **No, one picture each**.
- 2 Look at the labels under each picture, such as **Coin 1 • Front**. If a picture is in the wrong place, tap  to move it earlier or  to move it later.
- 3 Tap **Next 6**  to see more pictures.
- 4 When everything looks right, tap the gold **Make coins** button.



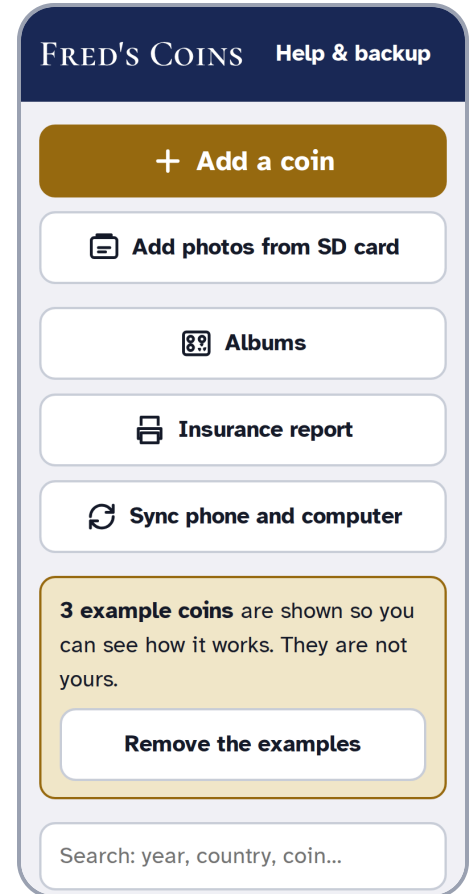
Tip: tap any picture to see it bigger before you decide. If a coin ends up with its front and back the wrong way round, open it and tap **Swap front and back**.

LOOKING AT YOUR COINS

The first screen shows all your coins as large round pictures, newest first.

- ✓ **Search:** type a year, a country or a word from your notes in the search box, and only matching coins are shown.
- ✓ **Open a coin:** tap its picture to see everything about it.
- ✓ **Go back:** tap **◀ Back** at the top left.

When you first open the app you will see **3 example coins**. They are pretend. Tap **Remove the examples** when you are ready.



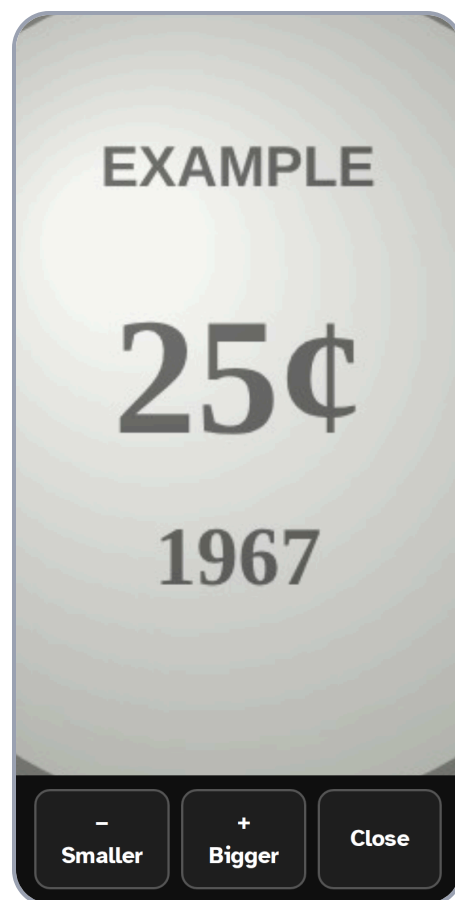
Zooming in and Making Changes

Zooming in

On a coin's page, tap **Zoom in on this photo**. Then use the big **+ Bigger** and **- Smaller** buttons, or spread two fingers apart on the picture. Slide one finger to move around. Tap **Close** when done.

Changing or deleting a coin

Tap **Change details** to fix anything. **Swap front and back** switches the two pictures. **Delete this coin** always asks you first, so nothing is removed by accident.



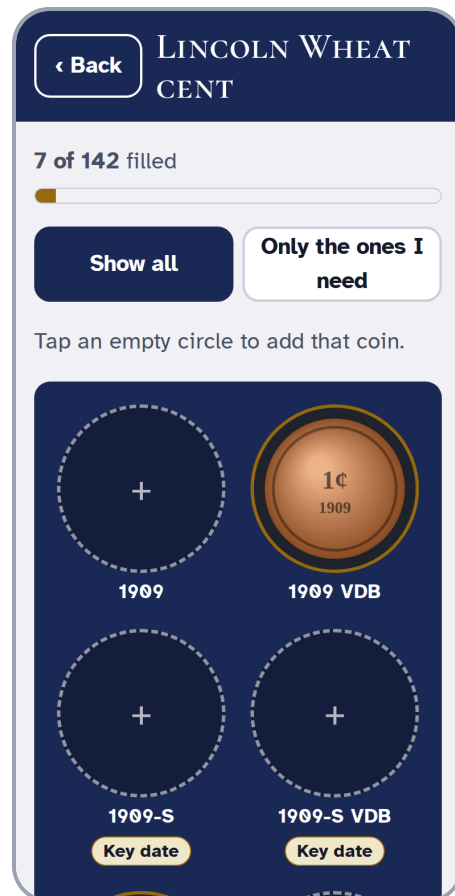
Facts about each coin

A coin's page also shows **About the coin**: the metal, weight, size, how much silver is in it, who designed it and **where to look for the mint mark**. Hard-to-find dates say **Key date**.

COIN ALBUMS

An album shows every date and mint mark of one kind of coin, like a cardboard coin folder.

- 1 On the first screen, tap **Albums**.
- 2 Tap the kind of coin, for example **Lincoln Wheat cent**. Each album shows how many spots you have filled, such as **7 of 142**.
- 3 Coins you have show their **picture**. An **empty circle with a +** is one you still need. Tap it to add that coin, with the details already filled in.



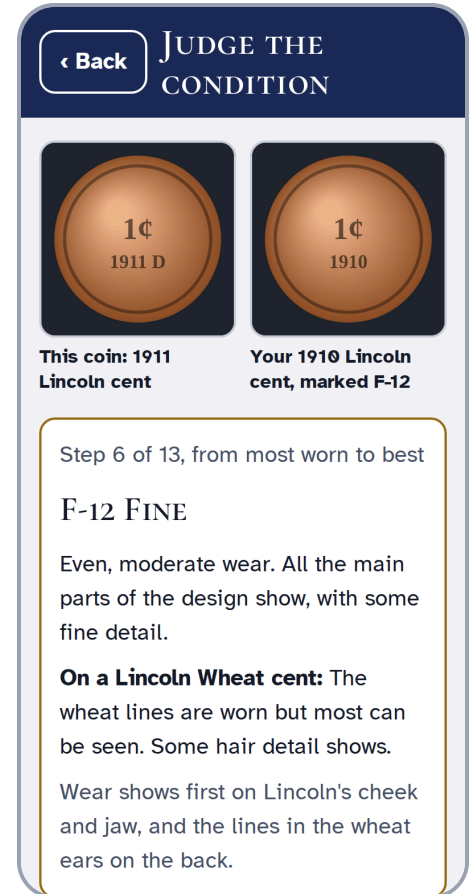
Going to a coin show? Tap **Only the ones I need** to see just the empty spots. **Key date** marks the hard-to-find ones.

If one of your coins is not in its album, open it, tap **Change details** and pick its **Type of coin** and date. Then tap **Show it in the album** to see its spot.

JUDGING THE CONDITION

Not sure if a coin is *Fine* or *Very Fine*? The app walks you through it.

- 1 Open a coin and tap **Help me judge the condition**.
- 2 Your coin is on the left. On the right is one of **your own coins** already marked with that grade. If you have none yet, the box offers **real coins on PCGS** instead. Tap a picture to zoom in. Below is what to look for on that kind of coin.
- 3 Tap **< More worn** or **Less worn >** until the words match your coin.
- 4 Tap the gold **Mark it ...** button to save that grade.



Photos from PCGS. PCGS, the coin grading company, shows photos of real coins at every grade. At the bottom of the same screen, tap **See the PCGS photos of each grade**. Their website opens in Chrome. Choose the kind of coin the app names, then compare. This needs the internet. Close Chrome's tab to come back to the app.

A LIST FOR INSURANCE

The app can make a printed list of your whole collection, with pictures and prices. It is useful for your **insurance agent** and for the **family**.

- 1 On the first screen, tap **Insurance report**.
- 2 Type your **name** in the box. The app remembers it next time.
- 3 Choose **With photos**, or **Words only** to use less paper.
- 4 Tap the gold **Print or save as PDF** button. Pick your printer, or choose **Save as PDF** to keep a copy on the phone or computer.

INSURANCE REPORT

This is a list of every coin with its photos and prices, ready to print or save as a PDF for an insurance agent or for the family. Example coins are left out.

Owner's name for the report

e.g. Robert Smith

With photos **Words only (fewer pages)**

Print or save as PDF

Coin Collection Inventory
Prepared October 6, 2026

Coins	Total price paid
8	\$85.10

1. 1909 Lincoln cent

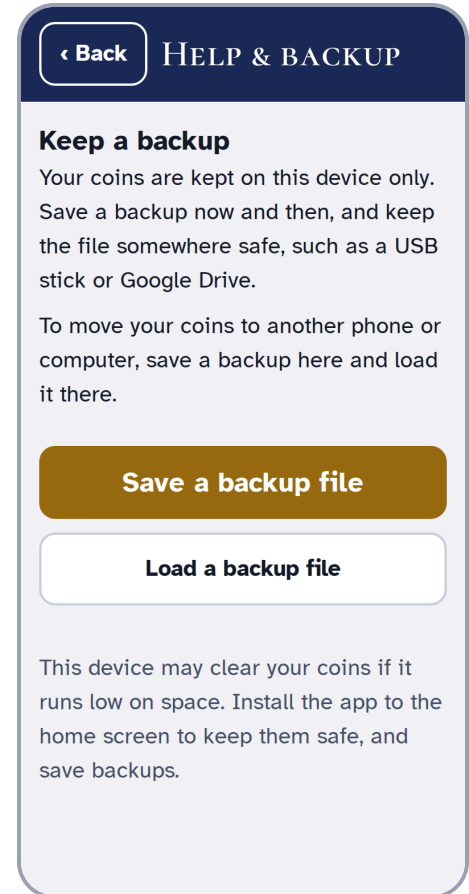
Print a fresh list once a year, or after you buy something special. Keep one copy at home and give one to your agent.

SAVING A BACKUP

Your coins are kept inside the app on that one phone or computer. A backup is a single file holding **all your coins and pictures**. If the phone is lost or broken, the backup brings everything back.

To save a backup (once a month is good)

- 1 Tap **Help & backup** at the top of the first screen.
- 2 Tap **Save a backup file**. It is named like **coin-backup-2026-10-06.json**.
- 3 Copy that file to a **USB stick** and put it somewhere safe.

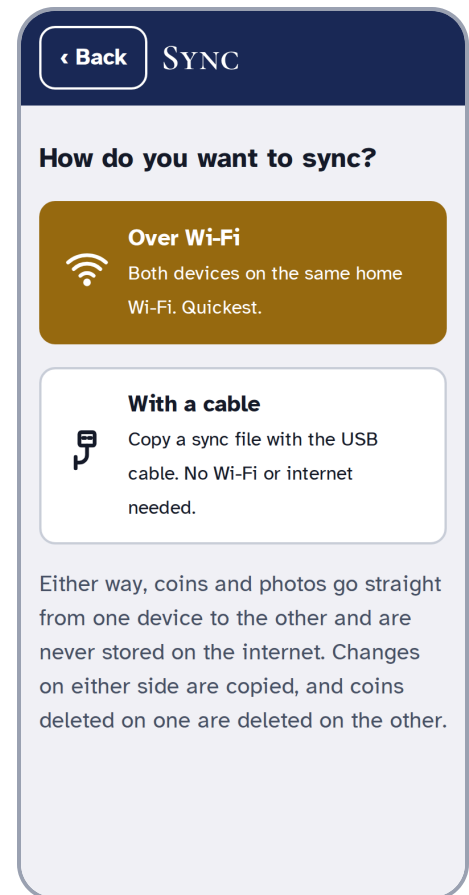


SYNCING THE PHONE AND THE COMPUTER

The phone and the computer each keep **their own** coins. **Sync** brings them together, so a coin added, changed or deleted on one is the same on the other.

- 1 On the first screen, tap **Sync phone and computer**.
- 2 The app asks how: **Over Wi-Fi** (quickest) or **With a cable** (no internet needed).

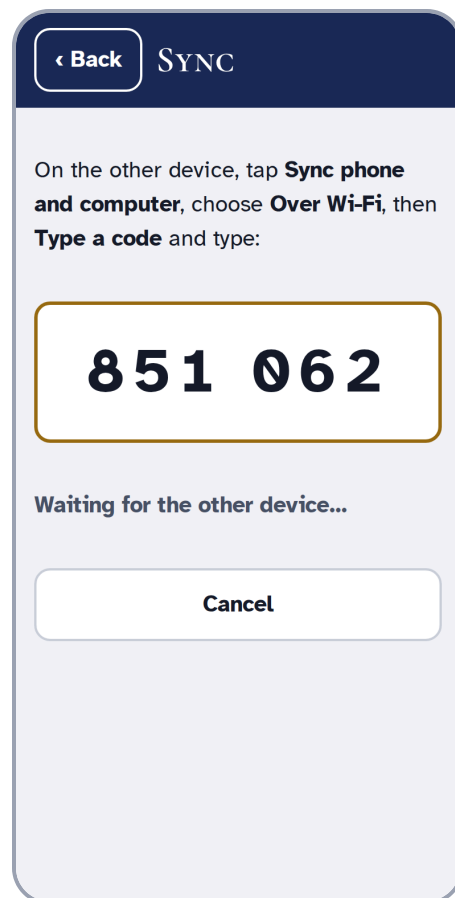
Either way, your coins and pictures go **straight from one device to the other**. They are never stored on the internet.



SYNCING OVER WI-FI

Both devices must be on the **same home Wi-Fi**, with the app open.

- 1 On the **computer**, tap **Sync phone and computer**, then **Over Wi-Fi**, then **Show a code**. A 6-number code appears.
- 2 On the **phone**, tap **Sync phone and computer**, then **Over Wi-Fi**, then **Type a code**.
- 3 Type the code and tap **Connect**.
- 4 Wait for **All done** on both screens. It also says how many coins came in and went out.



It doesn't matter which device shows the code. If it says it can't reach the other device, check that both are on the same Wi-Fi and try again.

SYNCING WITH A CABLE

No Wi-Fi? A **sync file** does the same job using the phone's charging cable.

From the computer to the phone

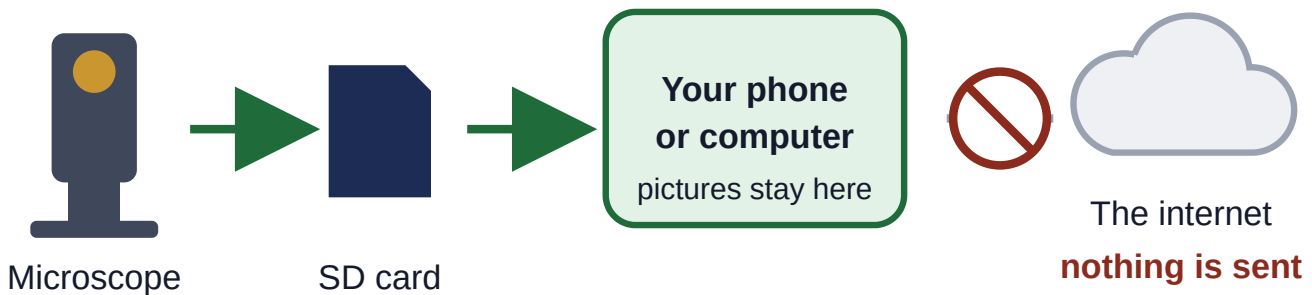
- 1 On the **computer**: **Sync phone and computer**, then **With a cable**, then **Save a sync file**. It is named like **coin-sync-2026-10-06.json**.
- 2 Plug the phone into the computer with its cable and copy the file onto the phone.
- 3 On the **phone**: **Sync phone and computer**, then **With a cable**, then **Load a sync file**, and pick the file.

From the phone back to the computer

Do the same the other way round: save a sync file on the phone and load it on the computer.

Loading a sync file only takes changes that are **newer**. Loading the same file twice does no harm.

IS IT SAFE? WHERE DO MY PICTURES GO?



Why it is safe

- ✓ **Your pictures stay with you.** When you add a picture, the app copies it into its own storage on that phone or computer. It never uploads it to the internet, and nobody else can see it. Sync only sends it straight to your own other device.
- ✓ **The internet only delivers the app.** The website sends the app to your device, the same way a shop hands you an empty photo album. What you put in the album stays at home.
- ✓ **No account, no password, no sign-up.** It never asks for your name, email, address, bank details or money.
- ✓ **No ads and no tracking.** The app contacts no one except its own website, to check for updates. Two exceptions: the **PCGS photos** button opens the PCGS website only when you tap it, and **Sync over Wi-Fi** uses a free service called PeerJS to introduce your two devices. Neither one ever sees your coins or pictures.
- ✓ **Your SD card is not changed.** The app makes a copy, so your original pictures stay safe on the card.

THE FEW RISKS, AND WHAT TO DO

- ! **Losing the phone, or clearing it.** If the phone is lost or broken, or Chrome's saved data is wiped, the coins on it are gone. *What to do:* save a backup once a month and keep the SD card pictures.
- ! **The backup file holds everything.** Anyone who has the file can see your coins, pictures and what you paid. *What to do:* keep it on your own USB stick, and do not email it to anyone you do not know.
- ! **The printed insurance list.** It shows what you own and what it is worth. *What to do:* keep printed copies somewhere private, and only give them to your agent or family.
- ! **The sync code.** *What to do:* only type it on your own phone or computer, and never read it out to anyone.
- ! **Someone using your phone.** Anyone who picks up your unlocked phone can open the app. *What to do:* keep a screen lock (PIN or fingerprint) on the phone.
- ! **Fake calls or messages.** Nobody from this app will ever call, text or email you. *What to do:* if someone says they are from "the coin app" and asks for money, passwords or to control your computer, hang up. It is a scam.
- ! **Copypcat websites.** *What to do:* only use the address on the front of this guide, **coinmax-coder.github.io/coin-catalog**.

QUICK HELP

I can't find the app

Look for the gold coin called **My Coins** on the phone's home screen, or in the computer's Start menu.

I only see recent photos, not the SD card

Tap  or **Browse** in the picture chooser and pick the SD card.

My coins are not on the computer

Tap **Sync phone and computer** on both and follow the steps (page 15).

A coin is not in its album

Open the coin, tap **Change details** and pick its **Type of coin** and date.

The writing is too small

On a computer, hold **Ctrl** and press **+**. On a phone, make the text bigger in the phone's Settings under Display.

Is my collection protected?

Open **Help & backup**. A line with a ✓ means the device will keep your coins permanently.

Who to call for help

Name: _____

Phone: _____